

4B GRAMMAR speculation and deduction

- a** Complete the conversation. Rewrite the phrases in brackets using *must*, *may*, *might*, *can't*, *could*, or *should*, and a verb.

Paul What's wrong, Helena? You look a bit worried.

Helena I think I ¹ *must have lost* (am almost sure I lost) my phone.
I can't find it anywhere.

Paul Isn't it in your bag?

Helena No, I don't think so. I've double-checked.

Paul You ² _____ (perhaps left) it at work.

Helena No, it ³ _____ (almost certainly isn't) there
because I remember having it when I was shopping after work today.

Paul Somebody ⁴ _____ (perhaps took) it from your bag in the supermarket.

Helena Oh no! I hope it's not a hacker who ⁵ _____ (is perhaps trying) to steal my identity.

Paul You'd better contact the bank and cancel all your credit cards just in case. It ⁶ _____
(probably won't be) a problem if you tell them what's happened – they can just block your account.

Helena Good idea. Can I use your phone?

Paul Here you are. Hey! Isn't that your ringtone? It's coming from the sofa.

Helena Ah, thank goodness! Here it is. It ⁷ _____ (almost definitely fell) out of my pocket
when I sat down after I came home from work.

Paul Yes, it ⁸ _____ (almost certainly did). Lucky you didn't ring the bank!



- b** Add one word in the right place to make the sentences correct.

- 1 The traffic is heavy today, so they're sure ^{to} be late for the meeting.
- 2 Medical experts say that the disease likely to spread all over the world.
- 3 Without an experienced guide, you probably be able to get to the top of the mountain.
- 4 The company is unlikely be in a position to make a profit this year.
- 5 If we play as badly as we did last week, we bound to lose in the semi-final.
- 6 It's very that you'll win anything. I'd say there's only a two per cent chance.
- 7 With her presentation skills, she's bound be able to convince the company to choose her proposal.
- 8 If Sophie doesn't get to the gate in the next ten minutes, she definitely miss the flight.

ACTIVATION

Prepare a short presentation about what you think life might be like in 20 years' time. Try to use the grammar from **a** and **b** above. Include two or three of these topics:

Entertainment Family and friends Shopping The economy The environment Technology Transport Work

*'First of all, I think it's **very likely** that 20 years from now I'll still have a small group of very close friends, although if I'm married, I **might not** see them as often as I do now. People will **definitely** still want to meet each other face to face, and I don't believe that email or chatting online will ever replace that. Families are **bound to** become smaller in the future as nowadays people are having fewer children and I think that the tradition of a large extended family **is likely** to disappear. Moving on to work, I think...'*